Text 1

第 1 段

Financial regulators in Britain have imposed a rather unusual rule on the bosses of big banks. Starting next year, any guaranteed bonus of top executives could be delayed 10 years if their banks are under investigation for wrongdoing. The main purpose of this "clawback" rule is to hold bankers accountable for harmful risk-taking and to restore public trust in financial institutions. Yet officials also hope for a much larger benefit: more long-term decisionmaking, not only by banks but by all corporations, to build a stronger economy for future generations.

直译：英国金融监管机构对大型银行的负责人实施了一项颇不寻常的规定。从明年开始，如果银行因不当行为受到调查，其高管任何已获保证的奖金都可能推迟十年发放。这项“追回”规则的主要目的，是让银行家对有害的冒险行为负责，并恢复公众对金融机构的信任。然而，官员们还希望获得更大的收益：不仅让银行，也让所有企业更多地作出长期决策，为后代建设更强健的经济。

第 2 段

"Short-termism" or the desire for quick profits, has worsened in publicly traded companies, says the Bank of England's top economist, Andrew Haldane. He quotes a giant of classical economics, Alfred Marshall, in describing this financial impatience as acting like "children who pick the plums out of their pudding to eat them at once" rather than putting them aside to be eaten last.

直译：英格兰银行首席经济学家安德鲁·霍尔丹说，“短期主义”，即追求快速获利的欲望，在上市公司中已变得更加严重。他引用古典经济学巨匠阿尔弗雷德·马歇尔的话，把这种金融上的急躁描述为像“从布丁里挑出李子并立刻吃掉的孩子”，而不是把李子留到最后再吃。

第 3 段

The average time for holding a stock in both the United States and Britain, he notes, has dropped from seven years to seven months in recent decades. Transient investors, who demand high quarterly profits from companies, can hinder a firm's efforts to invest in long-term research or to build up customer loyalty. This has been dubbed "quarterly capitalism." In addition, new digital technologies have allowed more rapid trading of equities, quicker use of information, and thus shorter attention spans in financial markets. "There seems to be a predominance of short-term thinking at the expense of long-term investing," said Commissioner Daniel Gallagher of the US Securities and Exchange Commission in a speech this week.

直译：他指出，近几十年来，美国和英国股票的平均持有时间，都已从七年降至七个月。那些要求企业实现高季度利润的短期投资者，可能阻碍公司投资长期研究或建立客户忠诚度的努力。这被称为“季度资本主义”。此外，新的数字技术使股票交易更加迅速、信息利用更加快捷，因此也使金融市场的注意力维持时间更短。美国证券交易委员会委员丹尼尔·加拉格尔本周在演讲中说：“短期思维似乎占据主导，而长期投资为此付出了代价。”

第 4 段

In the US, the Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002 has pushed most public companies to defer performance bonuses for senior executives by about a year, slightly helping reduce "short-termism." In its latest survey of CEO pay, The Wall Street Journal finds that "a substantial part" of executive pay is now tied to performance.

直译：在美国，二○○二年的《萨班斯—奥克斯利法案》推动大多数上市公司把高管绩效奖金推迟约一年发放，对减少“短期主义”略有帮助。《华尔街日报》在其最新的首席执行官薪酬调查中发现，如今高管薪酬的“相当大一部分”与绩效挂钩。

第 5 段

Much more could be done to encourage "long-termism," such as changes in the tax code and quicker disclosure of stock acquisitions. In France, shareholders who hold onto a company investment for at least two years can sometimes earn more voting rights in a company.

直译：为了鼓励“长期主义”，还可以做得更多，例如修改税法，以及更快披露股票收购信息。在法国，持有一家公司投资至少两年的股东，有时可以在公司中获得更多投票权。

第 6 段

Within companies, the right compensation design can provide incentives for executives to think beyond their own time at the company and on behalf of all stakeholders. Britain's new rule is a reminder to bankers that society has an interest in their performance, not just for the short term but for the long term.

直译：在公司内部，恰当的薪酬设计能够激励高管，把思考范围扩展到自己任职期之外，并为所有利益相关者着想。英国的新规定提醒银行家：社会关心他们的表现，而且不仅关心短期表现，也关心长期表现。

Text 2

第 1 段

Grade inflation —the gradual increase in average GPAs (grade-point averages) over the past few decades —is often considered a product of a consumer era in higher education, in which students are treated like customers to be pleased. But another, related force —a policy often buried deep in course catalogs called "grade forgiveness" —is helping raise GPAs.

直译：成绩膨胀，即过去几十年间平均 GPA（平均绩点）逐步上升，常被视为高等教育消费时代的产物；在这个时代，学生被当作需要取悦的顾客。但是，另一股相关力量也在推动 GPA 上升：一项通常深藏于课程目录之中、被称为“成绩宽恕”的政策。

第 2 段

Grade forgiveness allows students to retake a course in which they received a low grade, and the most recent grade or the highest grade is the only one that counts in calculating a student's overall GPA.

直译：成绩宽恕允许学生重修一门曾获得低分的课程；在计算学生总体 GPA 时，只计入最近一次或最高的一次成绩。

第 3 段

The use of this little-known practice has accelerated in recent years, as colleges continue to do their utmost to keep students in school (and paying tuition) and improve their graduation rates. When this practice first started decades ago, it was usually limited to freshmen, to give them a second chance to take a class in their first year if they struggled in their transition to college-level courses. But now most colleges, save for many selective campuses, allow all undergraduates, and even graduate students, to get their low grades forgiven.

直译：近年来，这种鲜为人知的做法加速普及，因为大学仍在竭尽所能地把学生留在学校里，让他们继续交学费，并提高毕业率。几十年前，这种做法刚开始时，通常只适用于大一新生：如果他们在适应大学课程时遇到困难，就给他们一次在第一年重修某门课的机会。但现在，除许多选拔性较强的学校以外，大多数大学允许所有本科生、甚至研究生获得低分豁免。

第 4 段

College officials tend to emphasize that the goal of grade forgiveness is less about the grade itself and more about encouraging students to retake courses critical to their degree program and graduation without incurring a big penalty. "Ultimately," said Jack Miner, Ohio State University's registrar, "we see students achieve more success because they retake a course and do better in subsequent courses or master the content that allows them to graduate on time."

直译：大学管理者往往强调，成绩宽恕的目标，与其说在于成绩本身，不如说在于鼓励学生重修那些对其学位课程和毕业至关重要的课程，同时不承受重大惩罚。俄亥俄州立大学教务注册主任杰克·迈纳说：“归根结底，我们看到学生取得了更多成功，因为他们重修了一门课程，因而在后续课程中表现更好，或者掌握了使他们能够按时毕业的内容。”

第 5 段

That said, there is a way in which grade forgiveness satisfies colleges' own needs as well. For public institutions, state funds are sometimes tied partly to their success on metrics such as graduation rates and student retention —so better grades can, by boosting figures like those, mean more money. And anything that raises GPAs will likely make students —who, at the end of the day, are paying the bill —feel they've gotten a better value for their tuition dollars, which is another big concern for colleges.

直译：话虽如此，成绩宽恕在某种意义上也满足了大学自身的需求。对公立院校而言，州政府资金有时部分取决于它们在毕业率、学生留校率等指标上的表现。因此，更好的成绩通过提高这些数字，可能意味着更多经费。而且，凡是能提高 GPA 的做法，都可能让学生觉得自己交的学费更加物有所值；毕竟，最终付账的是他们。这也是大学十分关心的另一个问题。

第 6 段

Indeed, grade forgiveness is just another way that universities are responding to consumers' expectations for higher education. Since students and parents expect a college degree to lead to a job, it is in the best interest of a school to turn out graduates who are as qualified as possible —or at least appear to be. On this, students' and colleges' incentives seem to be aligned.

直译：实际上，成绩宽恕不过是大学回应消费者对高等教育期待的又一种方式。既然学生和家长期待大学学位能带来工作，那么培养尽可能合格——或者至少看上去合格——的毕业生，就最符合学校的利益。在这一点上，学生与大学的动机似乎是一致的。

Text 3

第 1 段

This year marks exactly two centuries since the publication of "Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus," by Mary Shelley. Even before the invention of the electric light bulb, the author produced a remarkable work of speculative fiction that would foreshadow many ethical questions to be raised by technologies yet to come.

直译：今年恰好是玛丽·雪莱的《弗兰肯斯坦，或现代普罗米修斯》出版两百周年。早在电灯泡发明以前，这位作家就创作出了一部杰出的幻想小说，预示了后来尚未出现的技术将引发的许多伦理问题。

第 2 段

Today the rapid growth of artificial intelligence (AI) raises fundamental questions: "What is intelligence, identity, or consciousness? What makes humans humans? " What is being called artificial general intelligence, machines that would imitate the way humans think, continues to evade scientists. Yet humans remain fascinated by the idea of robots that would look, move, and respond like humans, similar to those recently depicted on popular sci-fi TV series such as "Westworld" and "Humans."

直译：如今，人工智能（AI）的迅速发展提出了一些根本问题："什么是智能、身份或意识？是什么使人类成为人类？"所谓通用人工智能，即模仿人类思维方式的机器，仍是科学家未能实现的目标。然而，人类仍然着迷于这样的机器人构想：它们的外形、动作和反应都像人类，类似最近在《西部世界》和《真实的人类》等热门科幻电视剧中描绘的机器人。

第 3 段

Just how people think is still far too complex to be understood, let alone reproduced, says David Eagleman, a Stanford University neuroscientist. "We are just in a situation where there are no good theories explaining what consciousness actually is and how you could ever build a machine to get there."

直译：斯坦福大学神经科学家戴维·伊格尔曼说，仅仅人究竟如何思考这一点，就仍然复杂得远远无法理解，更不用说复制了。"我们目前的处境是，没有好的理论能够解释意识究竟是什么，以及你究竟怎样才能造出一台达到那种程度的机器。"

第 4 段

But that doesn't mean crucial ethical issues involving AI aren't at hand. The coming use of autonomous vehicles, for example, poses thorny ethical questions. Human drivers sometimes must make split-second decisions. Their reactions may be a complex combination of instant reflexes, input from past driving experiences, and what their eyes and ears tell them in that moment. AI "vision" today is not nearly as sophisticated as that of humans. And to anticipate every imaginable driving situation is a difficult programming problem.

直译：但这并不意味着，涉及人工智能的重要伦理问题尚未迫近。例如，即将投入使用的自动驾驶汽车，就提出了棘手的伦理问题。人类驾驶员有时必须在一瞬间作出决定。他们的反应可能是即时反射、过往驾驶经验提供的信息，以及当时眼睛和耳朵所传来信息的复杂结合。如今，人工智能的"视觉"远没有人类那样精密。而预先考虑每一种可以想象的驾驶情境，则是一个困难的编程问题。

第 5 段

Whenever decisions are based on masses of data, “you quickly get into a lot of ethical questions,” notes Tan Kiat How, chief executive of a Singapore-based agency that is helping the government develop a voluntary code for the ethical use of AI. Along with Singapore, other governments and mega-corporations are beginning to establish their own guidelines. Britain is setting up a data ethics center. India released its AI ethics strategy this spring.

直译：新加坡一家机构的负责人陈杰豪指出，只要决策建立在大量数据之上，“ 你就会迅速遇到许多伦理问题 ”。该机构正帮助政府制定一套自愿遵守的人工智能伦理使用准则。与新加坡一样，其他政府和大型企业也开始建立自己的指导原则。英国正在设立一个数据伦理中心。印度于今年春季发布了人工智能伦理战略。

第 6 段

On June 7 Google pledged not to “design or deploy AI” that would cause “overall harm,” or to develop AI-directed weapons or use AI for surveillance that would violate international norms. It also pledged not to deploy AI whose use would violate international laws or human rights.

直译：六月七日，谷歌承诺，不会 “ 设计或部署 ” 会造成 “ 总体伤害 ” 的人工智能，不会开发由人工智能操控的武器，也不会把人工智能用于违反国际准则的监控。它还承诺，不部署其用途会违反国际法或侵犯人权的人工智能。

第 7 段

While the statement is vague, it represents one starting point. So does the idea that decisions made by AI systems should be explainable, transparent, and fair.

直译：虽然这份声明含糊不清，但它代表了一个起点。人工智能系统所作的决策应当可解释、透明且公平，这一理念同样代表了一个起点。

第 8 段

To put it another way: How can we make sure that the thinking of intelligent machines reflects humanity’s highest values? Only then will they be useful servants and not Frankenstein’s out-of-control monster.

直译：换句话说：我们如何确保智能机器的思维反映人类最高的价值观？只有这样，它们才会成为有用的仆人，而不是弗兰肯斯坦笔下失控的怪物。

Text 4

第 1 段

States will be able to force more people to pay sales tax when they make online purchases under a Supreme Court decision Thursday that will leave shoppers with lighter wallets but is a big financial win for states.

直译：根据最高法院星期四作出的一项裁决，各州将能够要求更多人在网上购物时缴纳销售税。这会让购物者的钱包变薄，却是各州在财政上的一场重大胜利。

第 2 段

The Supreme Court's opinion Thursday overruled a pair of decades-old decisions that states said cost them billions of dollars in lost revenue annually. The decisions made it more difficult for states to collect sales tax on certain online purchases.

直译：最高法院星期四的判决意见推翻了两项已有数十年历史的裁决。各州表示，这两项裁决使它们每年损失数十亿美元收入，因为它们使各州更难对某些网购交易征收销售税。

第 3 段

The cases the court overturned said that if a business was shipping a customer's purchase to a state where the business didn't have a physical presence such as a warehouse or office, the business didn't have to collect sales tax for the state. Customers were generally responsible for paying the sales tax to the state themselves if they weren't charged it, but most didn't realize they owed it and few paid.

直译：法院推翻的判例规定：如果一家企业把顾客购买的商品运往某个州，而该企业在该州没有仓库或办公室之类的实体存在，那么它就不必为该州代收销售税。如果商家没有收税，顾客通常有责任自行向州政府缴纳销售税，但大多数人不知道自己欠这笔税，很少有人缴纳。

第 4 段

Justice Anthony Kennedy wrote that the previous decisions were flawed. "Each year the physical presence rule becomes further removed from economic reality and results in significant revenue losses to the States," he wrote in an opinion joined by four other justices. Kennedy wrote that the rule "limited states' ability to seek long-term prosperity and has prevented market participants from competing on an even playing field."

直译：大法官安东尼·肯尼迪写道，先前的裁决存在缺陷。他在一份得到另外四名大法官赞同的判决意见中写道："实体存在规则每年都进一步脱离经济现实，并导致各州蒙受重大税收损失。"肯尼迪写道，该规则"限制了各州寻求长期繁荣的能力，并阻止市场参与者在公平环境中竞争"。

第 5 段

The ruling is a victory for big chains with a presence in many states, since they usually collect sales tax on online purchases already. Now, rivals will be charging sales tax where they hadn't before. Big chains have been collecting sales tax nationwide because they typically have physical stores in whatever state a purchase is being shipped to. Amazon.com, with its network of warehouses, also collects sales tax in every state that charges it, though third-party sellers who use the site don't have to.

直译：这项裁决是那些在许多州都有实体经营场所的大型连锁商家的胜利，因为它们通常早已对网购交易代收销售税。如今，竞争对手也将开始在过去不收税的地方收取销售税。大型连锁商家一直在全国范围内代收销售税，因为通常无论商品运往哪个州，它们都在该州有实体门店。拥有仓库网络的亚马逊也在每个征收销售税的州代收该税，不过使用该网站的第三方卖家此前不必如此。

第 6 段

Until now, many sellers that have a physical presence in only a single state or a few states have been able to avoid charging sales taxes when they ship to addresses outside those states. Sellers that use eBay and Etsy, which provide platforms for smaller sellers, also haven't been collecting sales tax nationwide. Under the ruling Thursday, states can pass laws requiring out-of-state sellers to collect the state's sales tax from customers and send it to the state.

直译：直到现在，许多仅在一个州或少数几个州拥有实体场所的卖家，在把商品运往这些州以外的地址时，一直能够避免代收销售税。使用为小型卖家提供平台的 eBay 和 Etsy 的商家，此前也没有在全国范围内代收销售税。根据星期四的裁决，各州可以通过法律，要求外州卖家向顾客代收本州销售税，并将税款交给州政府。

第 7 段

Retail trade groups praised the ruling, saying it levels the playing field for local and online businesses. The losers, said retail analyst Neil Saunders, are online-only retailers, especially smaller ones. Those retailers may face headaches complying with various state sales tax laws. The Small Business & Entrepreneurship Council advocacy group said in a statement, "Small businesses and internet entrepreneurs are not well served at all by this decision."

直译：零售行业团体称赞这一裁决，表示它使本地企业与网络企业处于公平竞争的环境中。零售分析师尼尔 · 桑德斯说，输家是纯网络零售商，尤其是规模较小的那些。这些零售商在遵守各州不同的销售税法律时，可能面临棘手问题。倡议团体 " 小企业与创业理事会 " 在声明中说：" 这项决定完全没有很好地维护小企业和互联网创业者的利益。"